

If you do have someone abroad, make sure you get the Crucial Ballistix series of DDR RAM for your system. Don't tell them the price though—get it as a gift!

The Processor

You can't compromise on this component at any cost. So which processor is the best? Undoubtedly the AMD Athlon 64 X2 4800+! This baby beats the pants off the nearest competition, the "other" dual-core, the Pentium D 840. These two cost about the same.



AMD and Intel processors

The performance of the X2 4800+ far surpasses that of its own cousins such as the FX-55 (which even now costs a bomb), while all the Intel processors, including the dual-cores, look up to it. The major thing we need to tell you about the 4800+ is not just that it's a dual-core; it's about the optimisations that have gone into it. If you have the moolah, look no further than the 4800+!

The Hard Drive

Seek times need to be faster, storage capacity higher, heat generation needs to be lower, and there needs to be a larger internal memory buffer. Does any hard drive possess all these qualities? Look no further than the Western Digital Caviar RE2 WD4000YR! It has everything. One question a true-blue gamer might ask at this point is, why have we chosen the WD hard drive, and not the Raptor one that spins at 10000 rpm? That's exactly the point. Higher spin speeds generate a lot of heat. This was minimised in the Raptor but not really eliminated. Another factor was the lower capacities in which the Raptor range is available. Hence the WD Caviar RE2 WD4000YR.